Fort Bend County District Court

Cause No. 2025-CV-0010

Shirley Rhodes, Plaintiff, v. Harbor Point Mutual Auto Insurance, Defendant

Oral Deposition of Shirley Rhodes

Date:	August 2, 2025
Location:	Offices of Mitchell & Hines Injury Lawyers
Examining attorney:	Richard Marshall, Ashford & Lyle LLP
Defending attorney:	Nicole Arias, Mitchell & Hines Injury Lawyers

Q: Please state your full name for the record.

A: I'd rather just say I'm the plaintiff in this case, if that's acceptable.

Q: That's fine for today, but I'll need your address and occupation before we finish. Let's talk about the accident. Where were you when it happened?

A: I was driving through an intersection in Houston, heading east on a main road with a green light.

Q: Did you see the other vehicle before the collision?

A: Not until the last second. A vehicle came from my right side and entered the intersection. I tried to brake, but there wasn't time.

Q: Which part of your vehicle was struck?

A: The driver's side door, right where I was sitting. The impact pushed my car sideways.

Q: Did you hit anything else after the impact?

A: No, the car came to rest against the curb on the far side of the intersection.

Q: Were you wearing your seatbelt?

A: Yes, I was.

Q: How did you feel immediately afterward?

A: Shaken, mostly. My left knee hurt right away, and it was hard to get out of the car without putting weight on it.

Q: Did you seek medical care that day?

A: An ambulance took me to the emergency room. They X-rayed the knee and wrapped it, then told me to follow up with an orthopedic doctor.

Q: Have you been to that orthopedic doctor?

A: Yes, I've been seeing them for several months now. I've had physical therapy twice a week and a few injections.

Q: How would you describe your knee now compared to before the accident?

A: Before, I ran a few times a week and had no problems. Now I can't run at all, and stairs are difficult, especially going down.

Q: How has this affected your daily life?

A: I had to stop coaching my nephew's soccer team because I can't stand for long periods. I also rely on my spouse for help with grocery shopping and carrying things.

Q: Have you missed any work?

A: I've taken time off for appointments and for a couple of flare-ups when the pain was too much to sit at my desk.

Q: Have you had any prior injuries to either knee?

A: No, not to my knowledge. My left knee had never given me trouble before this.

Q: Is there anything else you'd like to add about how the accident has affected you?

A: Mostly that I'm frustrated. I used to be active without thinking about it, and now every day involves planning around my knee.